ENGLISH B2 · ADVANCED GRAMMAR

Future continuous and future perfect

Locate an activity in progress at a future point or a completed result before a future deadline. The lesson connects form, meaning, register and real editorial decisions rather than treating the pattern as an isolated rule.

THE CENTRAL IDEA

Use future continuous and future perfect to distinguish future process, completion and duration in relation to a reference point while preserving the intended meaning and register.

Locate an activity in progress at a future point or a completed result before a future deadline.

MODEL

By Friday, we will have completed the first phase.

will be + -ing | will have + participle | will have been + -ing

6 GUIDED STAGES · 30 LEARNING DECISIONS

This complete guide combines explanation, visual reasoning, practice and feedback. Separate exercise and answer-key editions are also available from the lesson page.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

OUTCOME 1

01

Recognise the main future continuous and future perfect patterns in authentic contexts.

OUTCOME 2

02

Choose a form that accurately expresses distinguish future process, completion and duration in relation to a reference point.

OUTCOME 3

03

Avoid errors that change time, agency, emphasis or speaker commitment.

OUTCOME 4

04

Use the structure appropriately in project planning, predictions, schedules and progress reporting.

Build meaning before form

Locate an activity in progress at a future point or a completed result before a future deadline.

What future continuous and future perfect communicates

Locate an activity in progress at a future point or a completed result before a future deadline.

The central purpose is to distinguish future process, completion and duration in relation to a reference point. A successful choice therefore preserves the proposition while making the intended relationship, viewpoint or degree of commitment visible to the reader.

At ten tomorrow, we will be presenting the findings.	an activity in progress at a specified future time
By Friday, we will have completed the first phase.	a completed result before a future deadline
In June, she will have been teaching here for ten years.	the duration of an activity up to a future point

How the pattern is built

Use this working formula: will be + -ing | will have + participle | will have been + -ing. The formula is a decision path: it identifies the trigger, the clause architecture and the element that carries tense or modality.

The model “By Friday, we will have completed the first phase.” shows the complete pattern in context. Rebuild the sentence from meaning to form instead of translating each word independently.

Choice	Structure	Example
Future process	will be + verb-ing	At ten tomorrow, we will be presenting the findings.
Future completion	will have + past participle	By Friday, we will have completed the first phase.
Future duration	will have been + verb-ing	In June, she will have been teaching here for ten years.

Choose by meaning, not by surface similarity

Neighbouring structures may contain similar words but perform different jobs. Compare the three reference patterns and name the intended effect before completing the sentence.

A reliable answer explains both why the chosen form works and why a plausible alternative would change the meaning, time relation, information focus or level of certainty.

Meaning	Best route
an activity in progress at a specified future time	Future process
a completed result before a future deadline	Future completion
the duration of an activity up to a future point	Future duration

Register, discourse and editorial control

This grammar is especially useful in project planning, predictions, schedules and progress reporting. Its value comes from helping the reader process a relationship efficiently, not from making the sentence sound artificially complex.

After editing, check recoverability, natural word order and consistency with the surrounding paragraph. If the marked structure creates ambiguity, return to a fuller or more neutral clause.

Reason through the pattern

The visual map moves from communicative purpose to structural trigger, then to the final clause. It keeps meaning and form visible at the same time so the learner can justify every choice.

01	02	03	04	05	06
will be	-ing	will have	participle	will have been	-ing

DECIDE IN THIS ORDER

STEP 1

Decision 1

Identify the communicative purpose before selecting a form: distinguish future process, completion and duration in relation to a reference point.

STEP 2

Decision 2

Locate the structural trigger and match it to one of the reference patterns.

STEP 3

Decision 3

Check time reference, clause relationships, agency and speaker commitment.

STEP 4

Decision 4

Read the complete sentence in context and confirm that its register suits project planning, predictions, schedules and progress reporting.

STEP 5

Decision 5

Compare the result with a neutral alternative and keep the marked form only when it adds useful meaning.

Compare forms and meanings

Use the table to justify each structural choice.

Pattern	Form	Model
Future process	will be + verb-ing	At ten tomorrow, we will be presenting the findings.
Future completion	will have + past participle	By Friday, we will have completed the first phase.
Future duration	will have been + verb-ing	In June, she will have been teaching here for ten years.

EXAMPLES AT A GLANCE

At ten tomorrow, we will be presenting the findings.	an activity in progress at a specified future time
By Friday, we will have completed the first phase.	a completed result before a future deadline
In June, she will have been teaching here for ten years.	the duration of an activity up to a future point

COMMON ERRORS

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not use the future perfect when the focus is the activity in progress.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not omit have in the future perfect.

EDIT THIS

Avoid this pattern

Do not use a stative verb mechanically in the continuous form.

Recognition in context

Choose the sentence whose grammar matches the stated communicative purpose.

A1 · MEANING DECISION 1

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: an activity in progress at a specified future time?

OPTIONS At ten tomorrow, we will be presenting the findings. · By Friday, we will have completed the first phase. · In June, she will have been teaching here for ten years.

A2 · MEANING DECISION 2

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: a completed result before a future deadline?

OPTIONS By Friday, we will have completed the first phase. · In June, she will have been teaching here for ten years. · At ten tomorrow, we will be presenting the findings.

A3 · MEANING DECISION 3

Which sentence best communicates this purpose: the duration of an activity up to a future point?

OPTIONS In June, she will have been teaching here for ten years. · At ten tomorrow, we will be presenting the findings. · By Friday, we will have completed the first phase.

A4 · INTERPRETATION 4

What does “At ten tomorrow, we will be presenting the findings.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS an activity in progress at a specified future time · a completed result before a future deadline · the duration of an activity up to a future point

A5 · INTERPRETATION 5

What does “By Friday, we will have completed the first phase.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS a completed result before a future deadline · the duration of an activity up to a future point · an activity in progress at a specified future time

A6 · INTERPRETATION 6

What does “In June, she will have been teaching here for ten years.” communicate in this context?

OPTIONS the duration of an activity up to a future point · an activity in progress at a specified future time · a completed result before a future deadline

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Form and function

Identify both the structural family and the meaning carried by each model.

B1 · FORM AND FUNCTION 1

“At ten tomorrow, we will be presenting the findings.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Future process / Future completion / Future duration · Gap 2: an activity in progress at a specified future time / a completed result before a future deadline / the duration of an activity up to a future point

B2 · FORM AND FUNCTION 2

“By Friday, we will have completed the first phase.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Future completion / Future duration / Future process · Gap 2: a completed result before a future deadline / the duration of an activity up to a future point / an activity in progress at a specified future time

B3 · FORM AND FUNCTION 3

“In June, she will have been teaching here for ten years.” uses _____ to express _____.

OPTIONS Gap 1: Future duration / Future process / Future completion · Gap 2: the duration of an activity up to a future point / an activity in progress at a specified future time / a completed result before a future deadline

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Guided discourse choices

Maintain accurate form and meaning across a connected sequence of decisions.

C1 · EDITORIAL PLANNING

Choose the model that expresses an activity in progress at a specified future time: _____. Choose the model that expresses a completed result before a future deadline: _____. Choose the model that expresses the duration of an activity up to a future point: _____. Choose the model built with will be + verb-ing: _____. Choose the model built with will have + past participle: _____. Choose the model built with will have been + verb-ing: _____.

_____
_____

WORD BANK

Available forms

At ten tomorrow, we will be presenting the findings. · By Friday, we will have completed the first phase. · In June, she will have been teaching here for ten years.

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Open reconstruction

Recover the missing structural trigger without a word bank.

D1 · INDEPENDENT RECONSTRUCTION

At ten tomorrow, we _____ the findings. By Friday, we _____ the first phase. In June, she _____ here for ten years. State the full structural pattern for Future process: _____. State the full structural pattern for Future completion: _____.

_____
_____
_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Controlled transformation

Rewrite the neutral source so that it performs the requested advanced function.

E1 · TRANSFORMATION 1

Rewrite “The presentation will be in progress at ten tomorrow.” using the Future process pattern to express an activity in progress at a specified future time.

_____
_____

E2 · TRANSFORMATION 2

Rewrite “The first phase will be complete before Friday ends.” using the Future completion pattern to express a completed result before a future deadline.

_____
_____

E3 · TRANSFORMATION 3

Rewrite “Her teaching will reach a ten-year duration in June.” using the Future duration pattern to express the duration of an activity up to a future point.

_____
_____

E4 · TRANSFORMATION 4

Rewrite “The presentation will be in progress at ten tomorrow.” using the Future process pattern to express an activity in progress at a specified future time.

_____
_____

STAGE CHECK

Pause before continuing

Underline the trigger or decision point, name the rule, and check that the meaning has not changed.

Communicative production

Use the grammar independently in realistic academic, professional and conversational contexts.

F1 · PRODUCTION TASK 1

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Future process to express an activity in progress at a specified future time, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F2 · PRODUCTION TASK 2

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Future completion to express a completed result before a future deadline, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

F3 · PRODUCTION TASK 3

Write two connected sentences about a realistic situation. Use Future duration to express the duration of an activity up to a future point, then add a neutral sentence that makes the contrast clear.

_____
_____
_____

07 · RETRIEVAL

Final self-check

Complete these prompts without reopening the guide.

R1 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: communicative purpose.

_____
_____
_____

R2 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: structural trigger.

_____
_____
_____

R3 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: meaning contrast.

_____
_____
_____

R4 · REVIEW FOCUS

Explain and exemplify: register choice.

_____
_____
_____

Recognition in context

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

A1

At ten tomorrow, we will be presenting the findings.

Future process is the best match because an activity in progress at a specified future time.

A2

By Friday, we will have completed the first phase.

Future completion is the best match because a completed result before a future deadline.

A3

In June, she will have been teaching here for ten years.

Future duration is the best match because the duration of an activity up to a future point.

A4

an activity in progress at a specified future time

The Future process pattern communicates an activity in progress at a specified future time.

A5

a completed result before a future deadline

The Future completion pattern communicates a completed result before a future deadline.

A6

the duration of an activity up to a future point

The Future duration pattern communicates the duration of an activity up to a future point.

Form and function

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

B1

Future process / an activity in progress at a specified future time

The structure belongs to the Future process pattern. Its communicative purpose is an activity in progress at a specified future time.

B2

Future completion / a completed result before a future deadline

The structure belongs to the Future completion pattern. Its communicative purpose is a completed result before a future deadline.

B3

Future duration / the duration of an activity up to a future point

The structure belongs to the Future duration pattern. Its communicative purpose is the duration of an activity up to a future point.

Guided discourse choices

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

C1

At ten tomorrow, we will be presenting the findings.

Future process: will be + verb-ing.

C2

By Friday, we will have completed the first phase.

Future completion: will have + past participle.

C3

In June, she will have been teaching here for ten years.

Future duration: will have been + verb-ing.

C4

At ten tomorrow, we will be presenting the findings.

Future process: will be + verb-ing.

C5

By Friday, we will have completed the first phase.

Future completion: will have + past participle.

C6

In June, she will have been teaching here for ten years.

Future duration: will have been + verb-ing.

Open reconstruction

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

D1

will be presenting

Future process requires “will be presenting” in this model. will be + verb-ing.

D2

will have completed

Future completion requires “will have completed” in this model. will have + past participle.

D3

will have been teaching

Future duration requires “will have been teaching” in this model. will have been + verb-ing.

D4

will be + verb-ing

Future process is built as will be + verb-ing.

D5

will have + past participle

Future completion is built as will have + past participle.

Controlled transformation

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

E1

At ten tomorrow, we will be presenting the findings.

will be + verb-ing. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended future process effect.

E2

By Friday, we will have completed the first phase.

will have + past participle. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended future completion effect.

E3

In June, she will have been teaching here for ten years.

will have been + verb-ing. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended future duration effect.

E4

At ten tomorrow, we will be presenting the findings.

will be + verb-ing. The rewrite preserves the core message while adding the intended future process effect.

Communicative production

Compare the form first, then read the explanation and name the rule in your own words.

F1

At ten tomorrow, we will be presenting the findings. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses will be + verb-ing accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F2

By Friday, we will have completed the first phase. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses will have + past participle accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

F3

In June, she will have been teaching here for ten years. The surrounding context would then state the same situation in neutral order or with a less marked commitment.

A strong response uses will have been + verb-ing accurately and makes the communicative purpose visible in context.

Diagnose the pattern, not only the score

Use this page to decide what to revisit in the complete guide.

CHECK · TRIGGER OR CONTEXT

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · AUXILIARY OR STRUCTURAL CHOICE

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MAIN VERB OR CLAUSE FORM

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____

CHECK · MEANING AND REGISTER

What went wrong? What rule will prevent the same error next time?

_____
_____
_____